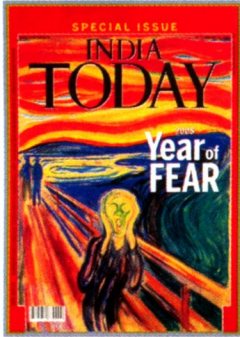


2008: The Year of Fear

JANUARY 12, 2009

Fear powered the year that ravaged the nation, and its story continues to be told in the sighs and sorrows of the living. In 2008, there was no equality in the power of fear... life was cheap; it was India at its stoic best.



“ We need to overcome the fear that has battered our nation. Terrorism’s ominous spell should be broken and peace by means of reciprocal understanding should be ushered in. ”

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

Fear Factor

The 26/11 Mumbai terror attack was the high point in a series of attacks that convulsed the nation throughout the year, and perhaps the very fact that whole of India came face to face with extreme evil saw acts of unparalleled bravery and sacrifice with ordinary people exhibiting extraordinary resilience, driving the fear out of fear. We have seen the worst and triumphed too. A toast to the undaunted spirit of India.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Edvard Munch’s “The Scream” aptly summed up the theme: fear. The agonising wail of the terror victim of bleeding India will never diminish from our minds, but hopefully by the end of this year,



Minority Matters

Minority Affairs Minister A.R. Antulay’s baseless remarks were made to enhance his sagging image in his own community and to help his party win back the confidence of the minorities before general elections (“Less Than Divine”, January 5). The Congress party’s stance, however, of treating the whole episode as inconsequential was disgusting.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, via www.indiatoday.in

Playing votebank politics is an old trick and Antulay’s comments were nothing but old wine served in a new bottle. By questioning the sacrifice of a brave cop, he revealed a lot about his own integrity and credibility.

K. VENKATARAMAN, via www.indiatoday.in

India would be beaming with renewed faith, waving the Tricolour over a clear, blue sky, signifying peace, stability and goodwill.

DR MOHAN MENON,
via www.indiatoday.in

Winning Stride

More than the terrorist who was named the news-maker of the year, one person who withstood the tribulations of time in the year of fear and came out unscathed was Ratan Tata (“Roller Coaster Rider”, January 5). His resilience is worth emulating. He began the year on a high note by announcing the launch of common man’s car—Nano—and ended it on an equally high note. Faced with stiff opposition from local villagers in Singur, West Bengal, he relocated his dream proj-

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